

54 MINILYRICS – LEARN YOUR SONGS

Imagine how easy it would be if you could read and sing every song you play in Winamp (or any other popular media player) without having to open a website every time? Enter MiniLyrics, a long-sought but little known solution for this irritating problem.



Install the MiniLyrics from this issue's DVD, and enable it from the player's console settings panel. You'll need to be connected of course.

55 PLAY PRACTICALLY ANY SONG ON EARTH

Even if you aren't a Last.fm user, give this extension a try. It lets you play practically any song on earth for free. It also scrobbles the song, that means they get added to your play count and add to the building of your musical taste which in turn lets you discover more music. You can play pause shuffle and control volume right there in your browser and use keyboard shortcuts to play any song on Last.fm (<http://goo.gl/VnEJO>)

56 NEW FIRMWARE FOR PMPS

This is a free alternative firmware and operating system to Apple's offering on the iPod Classic. With the Rockbox, you can change UI, do loads of other funky stuff and give a new lease of life to that ageing iPod Classic you've ignoring



for a while. Rockbox is supported by various top media players like Cowon, Samsung, SanDisk, Philips, iRiver and more.

57 SING ALONG TO KARAOKE

If you always wanted to turn your PC into a karaoke machine, and never had much success, then you're in luck. Winamp has a .CDG plugin which lets

you become a karaoke star within minutes.

So here's how it works: you download MP3 + CDG files for the songs in your karaoke playlist, and play it via Winamp. The free CDG plugin detects when a CDG file is played and gives you accompanying scrolling text for a number that is devoid of vocals.

58 PLAY HD VIDEOS ON A NETBOOK

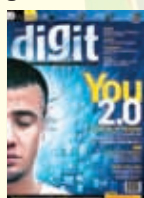
Try the KMPlayer and Media Player Classic, both of these support hard-



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ware acceleration natively for any type of video. Using these players, you should be able to play HD 720p video files using codecs like XviD, DivX, or MPEG-2 -- AVC/H.264 found in most MKV, MP4 files might still be too much for your netbook. But when you use these players to play HD on your netbook, there's a better chance of the video playing smoothly vis-a-vis from a different player.

Gaming Tweaks

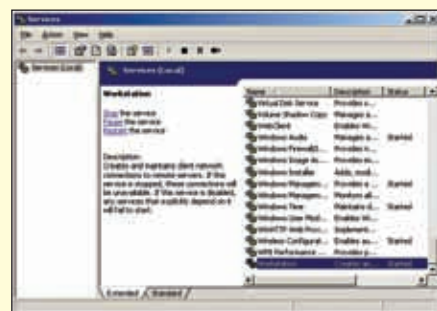
Hardcore or casual, gaming is something we all like. This section will tell you how to get the most out of your rig.

Jayesh Shinde and Anshuman Sanghvi
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Advisory: If you don't have a half decent system these tips may not work. Still they're akin to figuratively tightening your machine's hardware or software screws. Proceed with caution.

59 DISABLE UNNECESSARY SERVICES

Windows XP is notorious to have a number of services running in the background that directly impact the performance of your system. You need to make sure you disable as many unnecessary services to avoid lag while fragging your opponent. Type



in services.msc in the text box after Start > Run. In the list that appears right-click on any entry to disable its status in the subsequent pop-up window. Stuff like Remote Desktop, Print Spooler, Network Location Awareness should be disabled. Also considering services like Fast User Switching Compatibility, Help